Application design book · Version 1.0 · October 2026

Bureau

The job hunt atelier

A local-first, Claude-powered workshop that scouts the best tech roles on the open web, weighs each one against who you really are, and writes every application by hand, in your voice, from your facts.

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Bureau is a working tool before it is a costume. The Renaissance kit gives it a memorable character, but every flourish has a job: a seal is a grade, a sash marks where you are, brass marks what is precious. When style and clarity disagree, clarity wins.

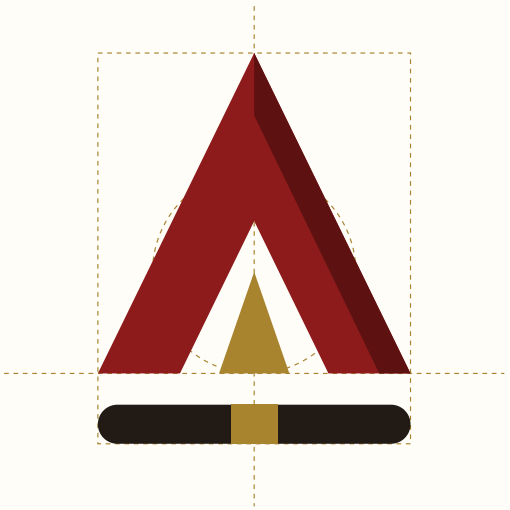
An assassin's *bureau*, for a job hunt

In Renaissance Rome, a master assassin ran a hidden bureau: scouts went out across the city, contracts came in, each one was studied, prepared for, and struck with precision, often without the master lifting a finger. Bureau runs your job hunt the same way.

The visual language is drawn from that era's most recognisable kit: the master's cream hooded robe, the crimson sash and cape lining, the oiled leather of bracers and belts, the brass of buckles and insignia, the steel of a concealed blade, and the parchment pages of a polymath inventor's codex. Bureau's insignia, palette and type are our own; nothing is borrowed from any game's trademarks.

IN THE BUREAU	IN THE APP	WHY THE METAPHOR HOLDS
The hunt	Autonomous loop	One switch: it scouts, weighs, tailors and applies on a timer
Scouts	Sources	16 connectors and a Claude deep scan that go out and report back
Contracts	Jobs	Every role is weighed before you commit time to it
Synchronisation	Fit score	How closely a role syncs with your real CV, 0–100
Wax seal	Grade	S · A · B · C · D, pressed only after Claude's assessment
Atelier	Studio	Where letters and tailored CVs are drafted
Codex	Profile	Your CV as the single source of truth
Dispatch	Outbox	What the hunt sent, and the few it hands back to you
Ledger	Pipeline	Every move recorded, from found to offer
Armory	Settings	Keys, engines and safeguards

A hood, a blade, a *strap*



Construction on a 64-unit grid

Anatomy

- **The hood**: a crimson arch, the shape of a raised cowl. Its right flank is shadowed to give it depth without gradients.
- **The blade**: a brass wedge rising inside the arch. The concealed tool, the precise strike.
- **The strap**: an ink bar with a brass buckle. The leather that holds the kit together, and a baseline for the mark.

Clear space & size

Keep clear space equal to the strap height (5 units) on every side. Minimum size: 16 px on screen, 6 mm in print. Below 24 px, drop the hood's shadow facet.

On every ground



Never

- Recolour the hood anything but crimson, cream or ink.
- Rotate, outline, or add a drop shadow or glow.
- Place it on photographs or busy textures.
- Pair it with any game's real emblem.

Robe, sash, leather, *brass*, steel

Six families, each lifted from one piece of the kit. Cream is the house colour and always the default theme.

Parchment
#F2EADB · the page
Robe & codex

Iron-gall ink
#211A15 · text
The codex hand

Sash crimson
#8E1B1B · accent
Sash & cape lining

Saddle leather
#5C3B26 · structure
Bracers & belts

Brass
#A8842F · focus, ornament
Buckles & insignia

Blade steel
#5F666D · neutral data
The concealed blade

Parchment ramp · 50 → 400

Hood white for raised surfaces, linen for cards, parchment for the page, vellum for wells, folded edge for strong borders.

Crimson · leather · brass



Each accent has a soft tint for backgrounds and a deep tone for pressed states and text on tints.

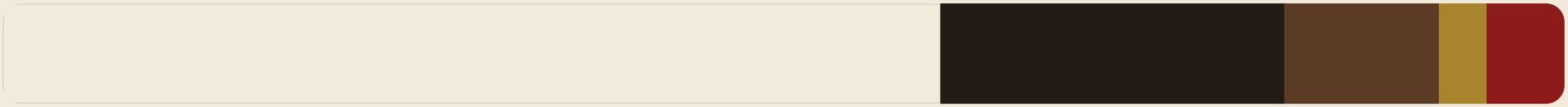
Olive · the only green



An Italian olive rather than a digital green, kept for "met", "sent" and "verified". It never competes with crimson.

Mostly robe, *a little* blood

Proportion



What each colour means

crimson	The one thing to do next (primary button), where you are (the sash), grades A and S, critical requirements, failure.
brass	Focus rings, ornaments, important-but-not-critical, grade B. Never used for body text.
leather	Structure and quantity: progress bars, the pre-filter, the scan console.
olive	Verified facts, met requirements, sent applications.
steel	Neutral metadata: sources, counts, unscored states.

Colour never carries meaning alone. Every state also has a word, a mark (✓ ~ ✕) or a position.

Night in Rome · opt-in dark theme

The same kit, *by lamplight*



Surfaces are warm umber, never grey or blue-black. Crimson lifts to #C4473D and brass to #CFAE5C so both keep their contrast. Cream stays the default; night is one click away in the sidebar.

A scholar's hand, an *engineer's* tools

Display · Cormorant Garamond 500 / 600 / italic

Every role, *weighed.*

A Garamond revival with high contrast and generous italics: the voice of a Renaissance codex. It's used for page titles, verdicts, letters, numerals and seals, never for dense UI.

Interface · IBM Plex Sans 400 / 500 / 600

Senior Security Engineer, Offensive Security

Plex Sans' slightly mechanical shapes sit well beside Cormorant and stay legible at 13 px in dense lists.

Numbers: IBM Plex Sans, tabular

79 USD 180k–240k

IBM Plex Mono appears only in the raw scan log.

Scale (rem)

Aa	Hero · 4.0 · display
Aa	Page title · 2.625
Aa	Section · 1.375
Aa	Row title · 0.9375 / 600
Aa	Body · 0.9375 / 400
Aa	Meta · 0.8125
Aa	Label: 0.8125, sentence case, never tracked capitals

All fonts are bundled locally (SIL Open Font License). Bureau makes no font requests over the network.

Speaks like a *mentor*, not a mascot

Plain first

Navigation and buttons use ordinary words: Jobs, Studio, Dispatch, "Draft application". The Renaissance flavour lives in eyebrows, headlines and empty states, never in a control you need to understand.

Honest always

Bureau never inflates. Scores come with their working. A missing must-have is shown as missing. The fact lock calls out invented claims, even in our own drafts.

Brief and warm

Short sentences, active voice, no exclamation marks, no hype. A good line reads like a trusted colleague: "4 strong matches await your eye."

WRITE	NOT
The scouts are out. Results will appear as they come in.	🚀 Scanning started!!
Claude declined this request (cyber).	Oops! Something went wrong.
The fact lock found 2 claims your CV doesn't support.	Your letter is ready to wow recruiters!
Nothing here yet. Loosen the filters, or run a scan.	No data.

Applications sound like you

Claude reads your CV once and writes down how you write. Every letter follows that voice plus your tone setting. The house bans: "passionate", "fast-paced", "team player", "leverage", "synergy", "I am writing to apply", flattery, and em-dash flourishes.

✓ Every number and employer in a draft must appear in your CV, or the fact lock flags it.

The seal, the score, the *sash*

Wax seal · grade



S ≥ 88	A ≥ 78	B ≥ 65	C ≥ 50	D < 50
Apply	Consider	Research		Skip

Each grade maps to a decision band. Pressed only after Claude's assessment. Unscored roles carry a blank pale seal. Sizes: 30, 40 and 64 px.

Score mark



79 / 100
Apply

The seal and a plain number, with the decision in words. It replaced a progress ring that only decorated the score.

Numbers

Every figure is set in IBM Plex Sans with tabular numerals. The serif never labels or measures.

Buttons

Draft application

Primary · one per view

Assess with Claude

Secondary

Export — Leather · rare, heavy actions

Dismiss — Ghost · tertiary

The sash

When the hunt is on, a band of crimson draws across the top of the Overview, the robe's sash made into a status. It's the one bold element; nothing else uses that colour at that scale.

The *workbench*

Tags

Security · via Greenhouse · apply · consider · email apply · critical · important · nice

Filter chips

All · Security · Game dev

Selected chips invert to ink, so they read as pressed without relying on colour.

Fields

Rest

Search title, company, stack...

Focus · brass ring

Penetration Tester

Letter · Cormorant 18px on hood white

I ran 40 pentests across 12 web apps at Acme...

Callouts

✦ Not yet assessed. Claude will read the posting and weigh it against your CV.

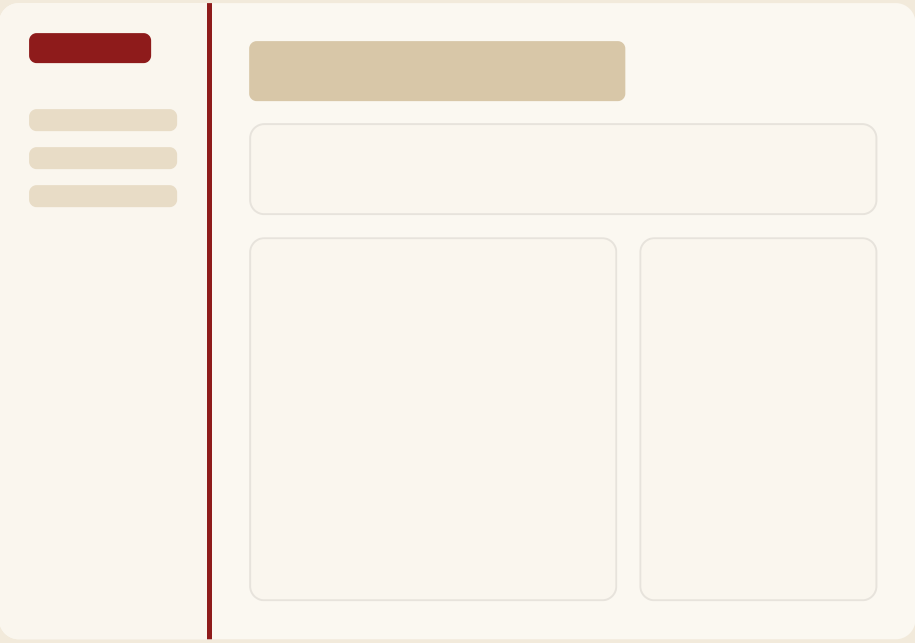
⚑ Red flags: unpaid trial task; personal Gmail, no company.

✓ Facts verified. Every claim traces to your CV.

Requirement marks

✓ met · ~ partial · × missing

Ruled like a *codex* page



Sidebar 248 px · fluid main column with 24–48 px gutters · content splits 1.55 : 1 (primary : context). Below 1180 px, splits stack; below 820 px, the sidebar becomes a top bar.

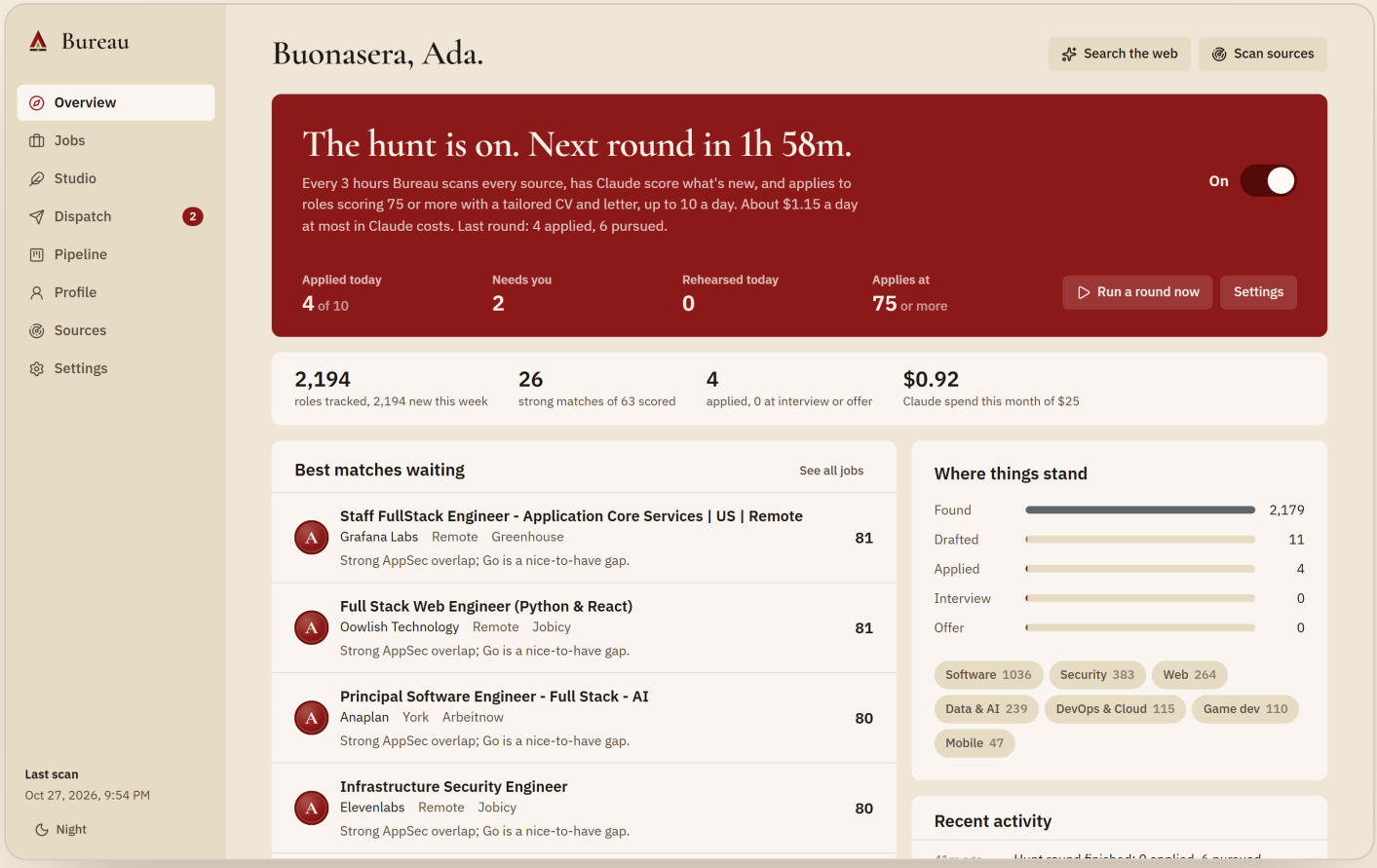
TOKEN	VALUE	USE
space	4 · 8 · 12 · 16 · 24 · 32 · 48 · 64	A strict 4-point scale
radius	4 · 8 · 14 · pill	Inputs · buttons · cards · tags
line	ink at 12% / 22%	Hairlines · strong borders
surfaces	parchment, vellum, linen	Separated by tone, not outlines or shadows
selection	a darker tone of the row	Never a coloured side border or glow
depth	leather 55%, y 18, blur 48	Only things that float: dialogs, toasts
motion	160–240 ms, ease-out	State changes only; one authored moment
ornament	none	Removing decoration leaves space; it isn't refilled

The one shadow is tinted leather, never neutral grey, so even depth stays warm.

Overview

The control room: the hunt as a crimson sash, then a one-line summary, the best matches waiting, and where everything stands.

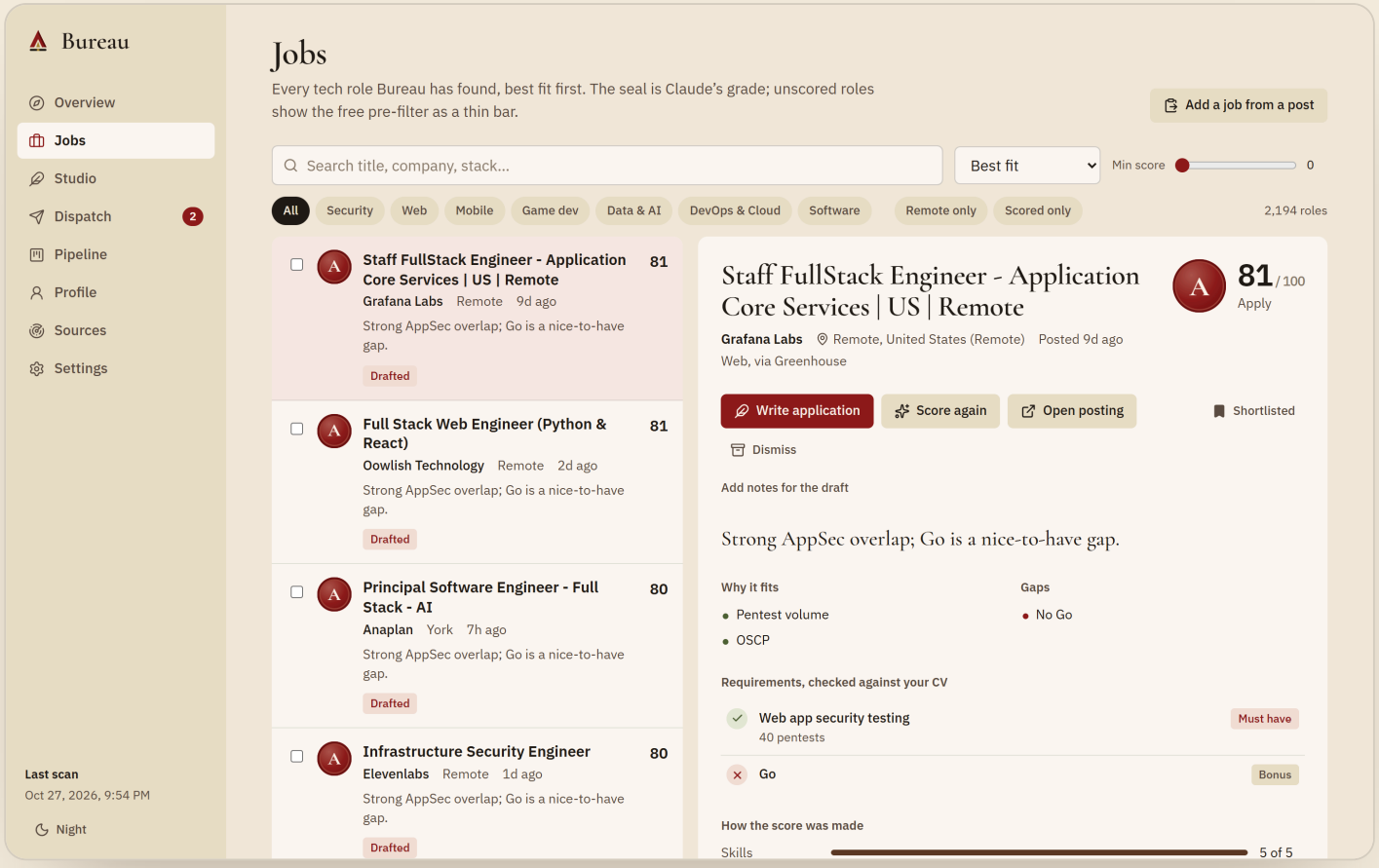
- The hunt band: status in one sentence, the switch, today's counts
- What still needs setting up appears inside the band
- A summary line instead of a wall of big numbers
- Best matches ranked by seal and score, with Claude's verdict
- Pipeline bars, disciplines, recent activity



Jobs

A ranked list on the left; on the right, Claude's full working for the selected role.

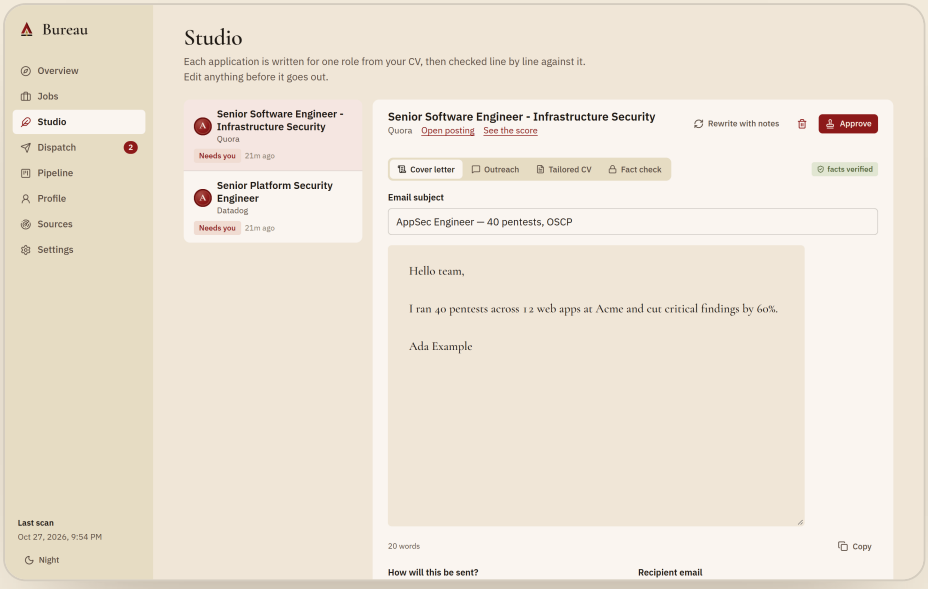
- Search, sort, minimum score, discipline chips, remote filter
- Batch-select to assess many roles at once
- Claude's verdict set in the serif, as the one line to read first
- Each requirement checked against your CV: met, partly met or missing, with proof
- The score's working shown: weights, legitimacy, confidence
- The posting itself, sanitised twice

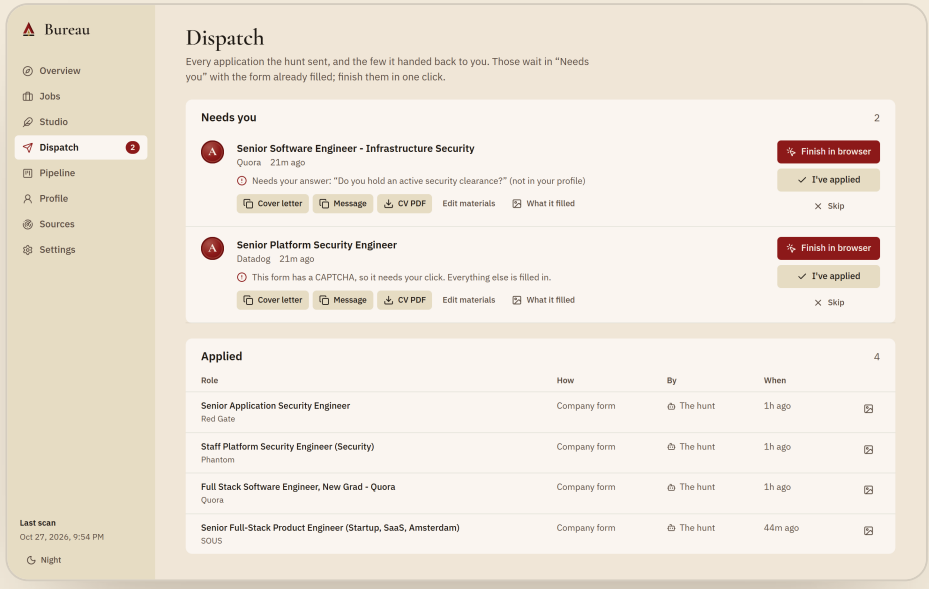


XIV · Screens

Studio & *Dispatch*

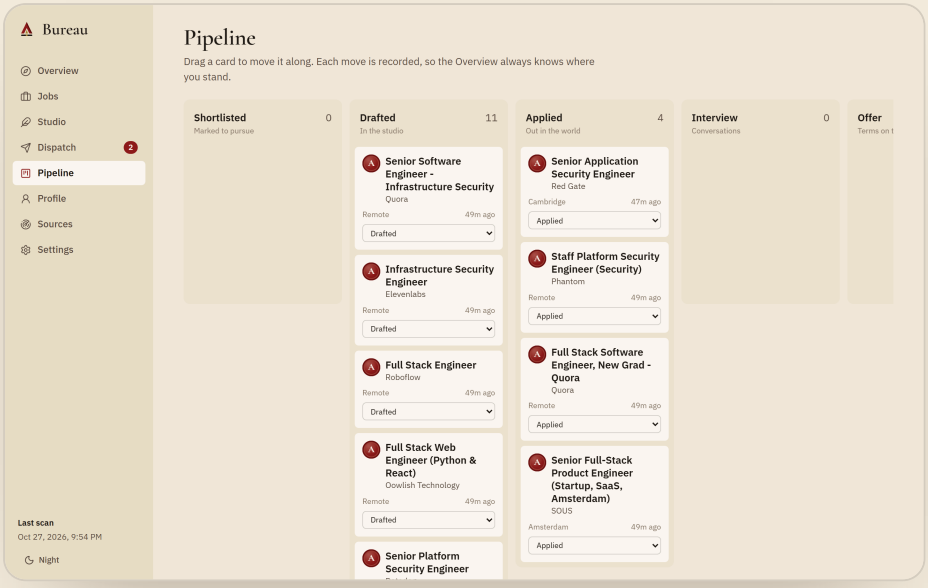
The Studio drafts a cover letter, an outreach message and a tailored ATS-safe CV for one role, then runs the fact lock. Dispatch is the hunt's outbox: everything it applied to, plus "Needs you", the forms it filled but couldn't finish honestly, one click from done.

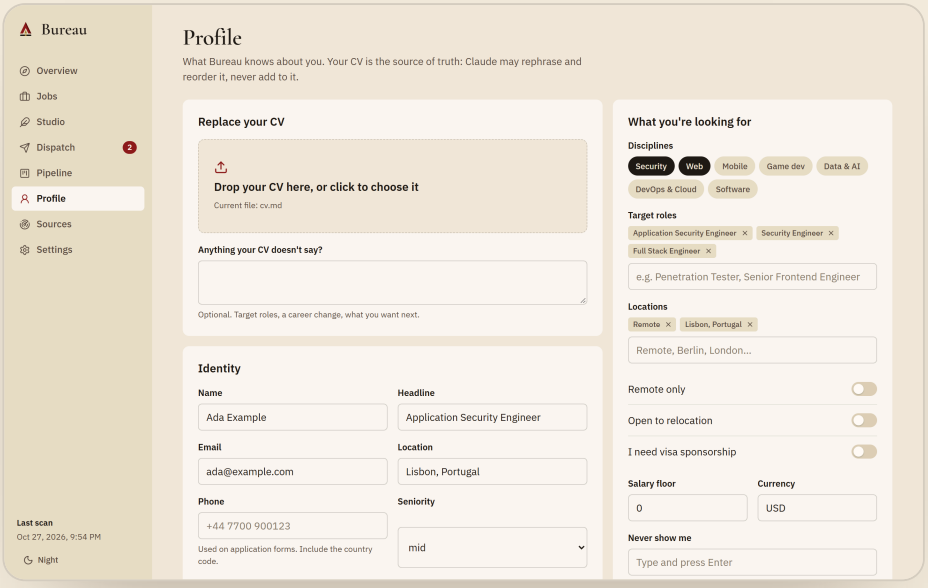




Pipeline & *Codex*

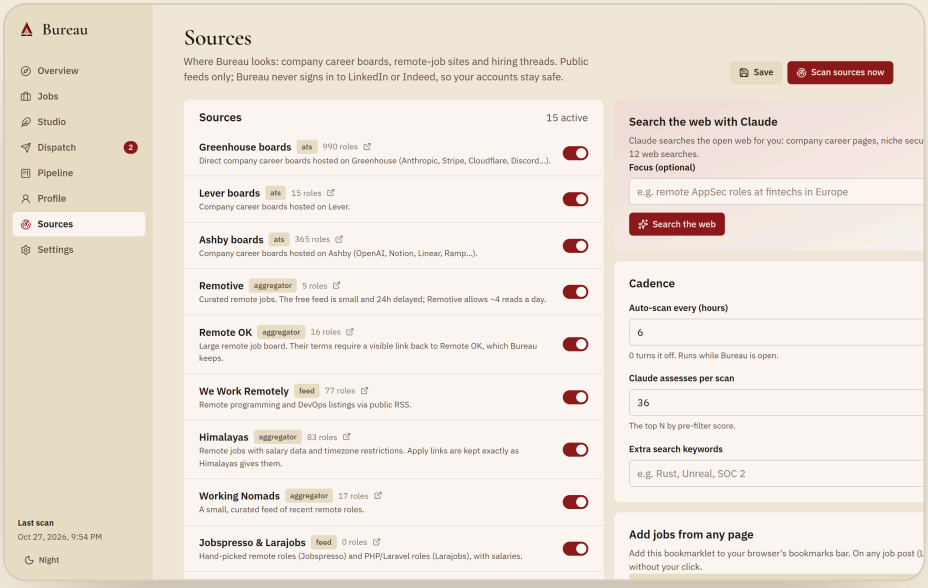
A drag-and-drop ledger from shortlist to offer, and the Codex: your CV read into a structured profile, your hunt preferences, your voice and your portfolio evidence.

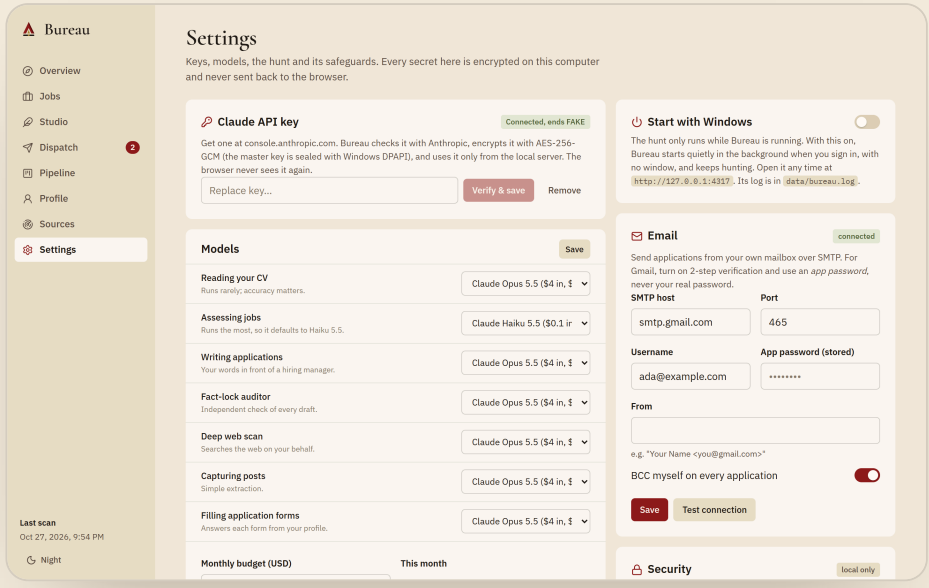




Scouts & *Armory*

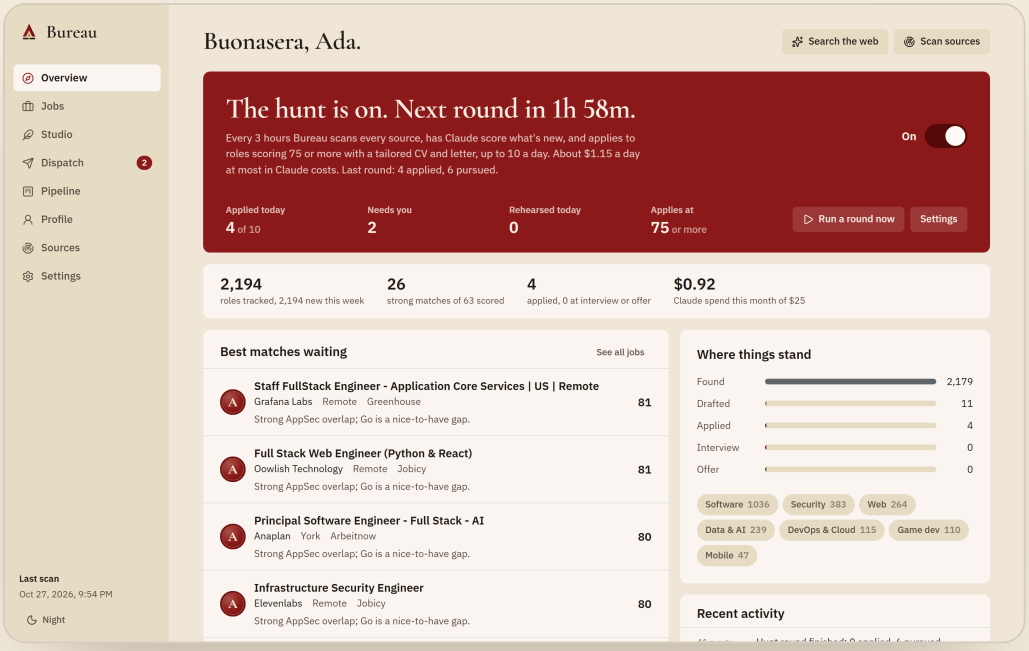
Sixteen connectors, curated company boards, cadence and the Claude deep scan, beside the Armory: keys, a model per task, budget, autopilot, email and security.





It hunts *while you live*

One switch on the Overview. While Bureau runs (it can start with Windows), each round it scouts, has Claude weigh what's new, tailors a CV and letter for every role above your bar, and applies by email or through the company's own form in a real browser.



What it will and won't do

- Applies through employers' own logged-out forms (Greenhouse, Lever, Ashby, Workable…) and by email. It never logs in to LinkedIn or Indeed.
- Claude answers each form from your profile and standing answers. Demographic questions get "decline to self-identify".
- Never solves a CAPTCHA and never guesses. Those roles go to **Needs you** with the form filled; "Finish in browser" opens it for your click.
- Only sends when the fact lock is clean. One automatic rewrite, then it stops and holds the draft for you.
- Daily cap, a stop button, and Rehearsal mode (fills forms, keeps screenshots, doesn't submit).

What it costs

Scoring a role	≈ `$0.001`	Haiku 5.5
One application	≈ `$0.34`	Opus 5.5: draft, audit, form answers
Defaults, running all day	≤ `$3.65/day`	8 rounds × 40 roles + 10 applications

Shown live in Settings, from your own spend once there's history. The monthly budget pauses the hunt when it's reached.

Every step, *in order*

□ code ■ Claude ■ you

i
Scout
16 public sources: ATS boards, aggregators, HN, Reddit RSS, game-dev feeds. Plus a Claude web deep scan.

ii
Gate
Free filters: is it tech, which discipline, dedupe by URL and fingerprint, freshness, deal-breakers.

iii
Pre-score
Discipline, title, skills overlap, logistics, recency, seniority. No tokens spent.

iv
Assess
Haiku 5.5. Pass 1: requirements from the posting alone. Pass 2: matched against the CV, with proof.

v
Tailor
Letter, outreach note, ATS-safe CV, in your voice, from your facts.

vi
Fact lock
Code checks every figure and employer; a fresh auditor lists unsupported claims. One rewrite, or it holds.

vii
Apply
Email from your inbox, or the company form in a real browser: fields answered, CV uploaded, submitted.

viii
Needs you
CAPTCHAs and questions only you can answer, pre-filled. One click finishes them.

The score is computed in code

```
requirements = Σ weight × match / Σ weight
  weight: critical 3 · important 2 · nice 1
  match:  met 1 · partial ½ · missing 0
dimensions = skills .30 + experience .20 + domain .15
           + logistics .15 + pay .10 + growth .10
score = .45 × requirements + .35 × dimensions + .20 × pre-filter
caps: stated must-have missing → ≤ 64 · dealbreaker → ≤ 40
      low legitimacy −25 · under-levelled −8
```

Why it's built this way

- Claude judges; code weighs. The same assessment always gives the same number, and the weights can be tuned.
- The free gate cuts thousands of listings to the few dozen worth tokens. Prompt caching keeps the rubric and profile warm across a whole scan.
- Job postings are treated as untrusted data. Injection attempts are flagged as red flags, never obeyed.
- Haiku 5.5 scores in volume; Opus 5.5 writes everything a hiring manager reads. Server-side fallback on refusals, a model per task, and a monthly budget cap.

Built to leave *localhost* safely

i **Loopback by default**
Listens on 127.0.0.1 only. It refuses to bind elsewhere unless a passphrase is set.

ii **Host, Origin & path guard**
Unknown Host headers are refused (defeats DNS rebinding), cross-site requests rejected, and every request guarded on its decoded path, so encoded URLs can't slip past.

iii **Session + CSRF**
256-bit HttpOnly, SameSite=Strict cookie; every change needs a per-session token a hostile page can't read.

iv **Passphrase lock**
scrypt ($N=2^{15}$) hashed, rate-limited, session rotated on login.

v **Secrets vault**
API key and SMTP password encrypted with AES-256-GCM; the master key is sealed with Windows DPAPI. Secrets are never sent to the browser and are redacted from logs.

vi **SSRF guard**
All outbound fetches validate every resolved IP at connect time, re-check each redirect, and block private, loopback, link-local and metadata ranges.

vii **Hostile content**
Job HTML sanitised on the server (sanitize-html) and again in the browser (DOMPurify), under a strict CSP: no inline scripts, no third-party origins.

viii **Uploads**
10 MB cap, type checked by magic bytes, stored under random names outside the web root.

ix **Prompt-injection posture**
Postings are fenced as data and can't forge the prompt's tags. An apply address is trusted only if it appears in that job's own text. The fact lock and the daily cap bound what the hunt can send.

x **The hunt's browser**
Every request it makes passes the same private-network guard. Fresh context per application, downloads off. It never logs in to LinkedIn or Indeed, so your accounts can't be banned for it.

Quiet motion, *open* doors

Motion

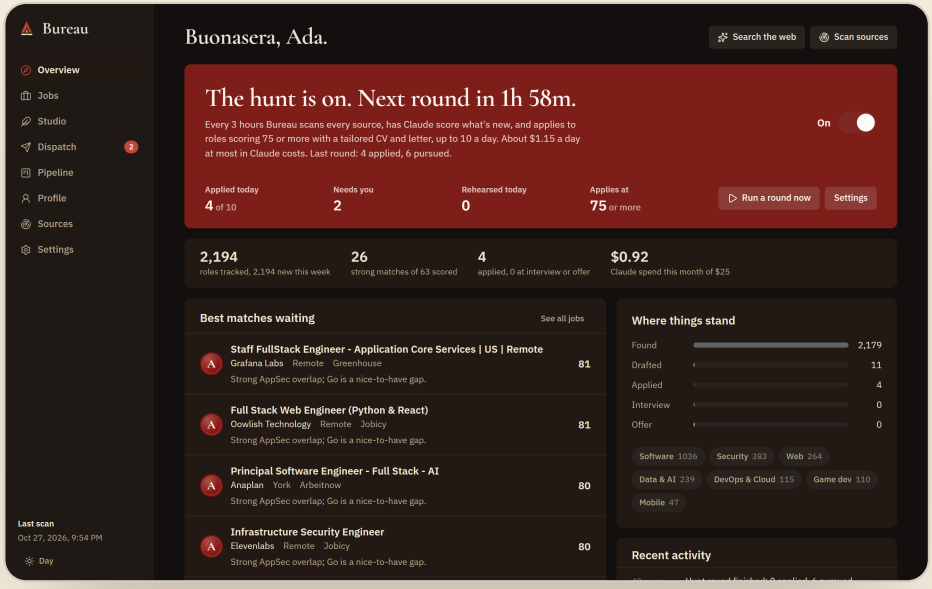
- One easing curve, cubic-bezier(.16,1,.3,1); 160–240 ms for state changes.
- One authored moment: the sash drawing across when the hunt starts. A thin moving line shows a round in progress. Nothing bounces.
- prefers-reduced-motion turns all of it off.

Accessibility

- Ink on parchment ≈ 14:1; crimson on parchment ≈ 7.8:1; white on crimson ≈ 9:1.
- Brass focus ring on every interactive element; full keyboard paths; selection, caret and scrollbars themed from the palette.
- Roles and labels on lists, tabs, switches, dialogs and live regions.
- States never rely on colour alone.

Colophon

Set in Cormorant Garamond, IBM Plex Sans and IBM Plex Mono. Built with Node 24, Fastify, SQLite, React 19, Vite, Playwright (driving your own Chrome or Edge) and the Anthropic TypeScript SDK. Icons from Lucide at a 1.8 stroke. Insignia and palette are original work for Bureau.



Night in Rome: the same atelier by lamplight.